FOSS4G BELGIUM 2026

Collaborative Data Collection with QGIS & Mergin Maps

What's new

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FOSS4G BELGIUM 2026

Mergin Maps

Open-source field data collection tool

Powered by QGIS

Collect. Share. Publish.

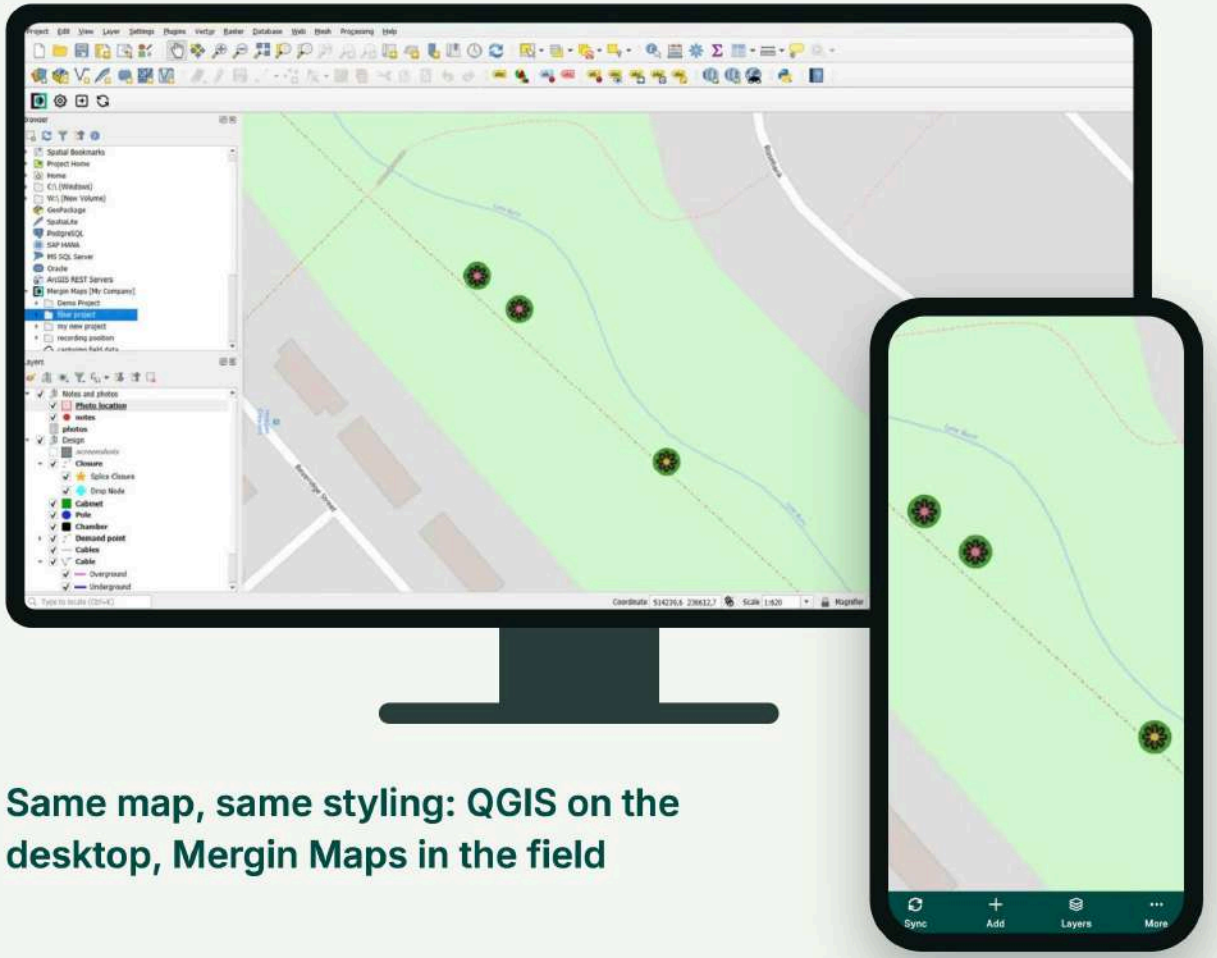
MERGIN MAPS

Collect. Share. Publish.

Workflow starts in QGIS: prepare maps and link them with Mergin Maps

- Mobile app for data collection and management
- QGIS reads vector layers, background maps and forms

  Texts, numbers, conditional visibility, relations, single and multi selects, photos
- External GNSS support
- Offline work
- Interface optimised for non-GIS-savvy collectors



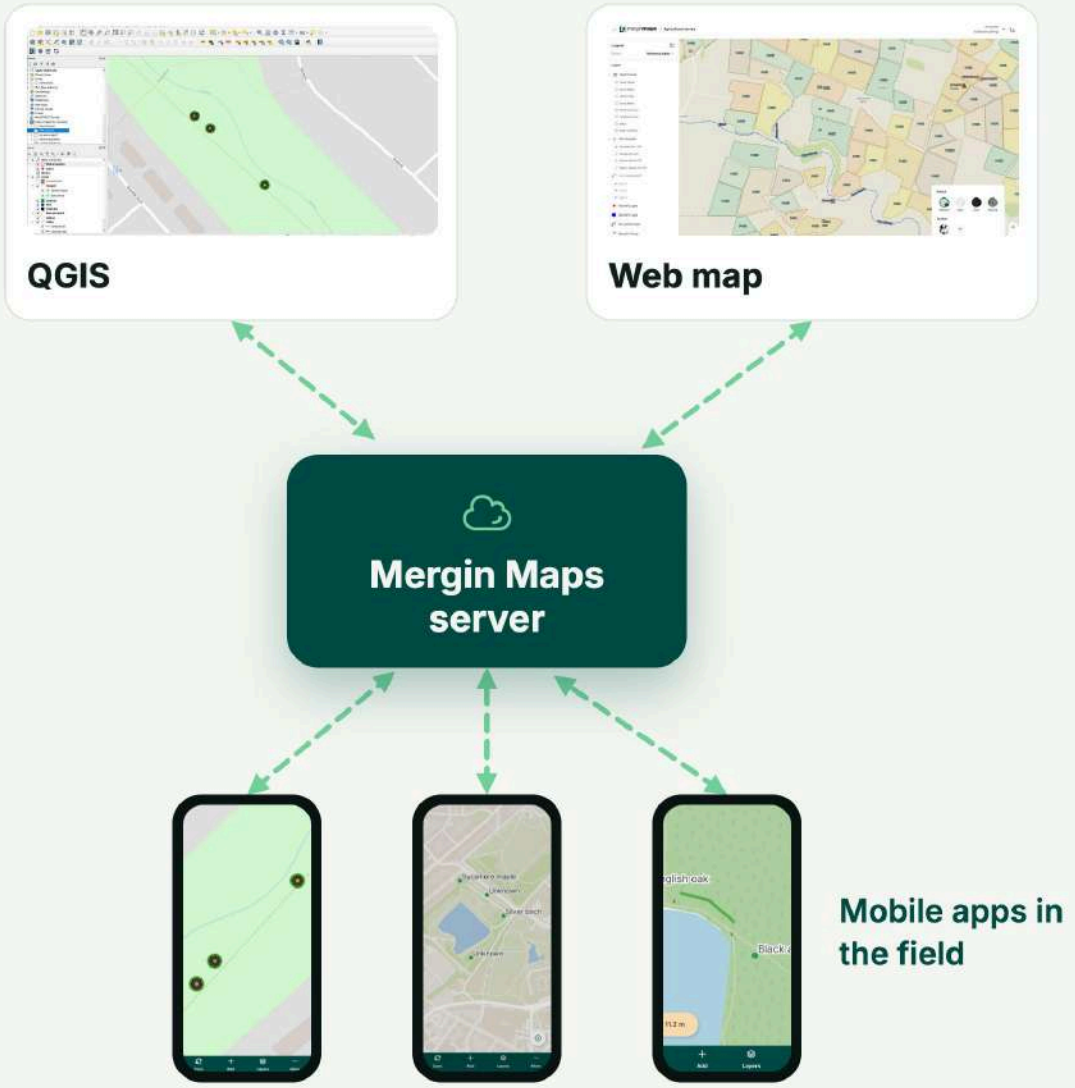
Same map, same styling: QGIS on the desktop, Mergin Maps in the field

MERGIN MAPS

Collect. Share. Publish.

All of it done in collaboration with colleagues

- Permissions to fit your team
- Data versioning
- Automatic data merging
- Preview and edit data in QGIS
- Preview data in web maps



MERGIN MAPS

Collect. Share. **Publish.**

Web maps* NEW	Share via URL, embed, custom exports via web map apps
OGC API* NEW	Connect your collected data with external systems
Sync with PostgreSQL	
Python API	
Manual download	
Reports from QGIS	

* Early access programme: reserve your seat

MERGIN MAPS

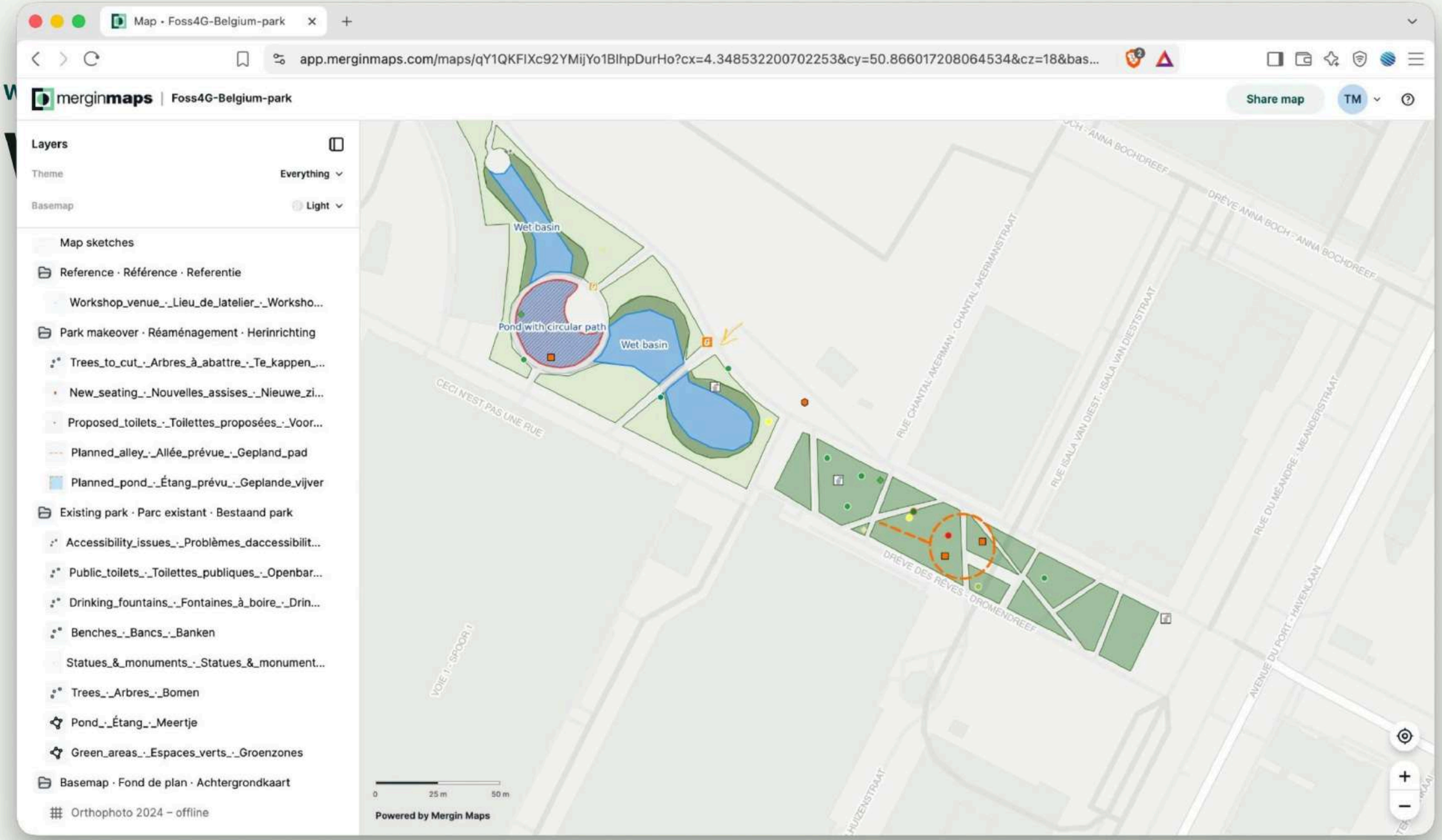
What's new

WHAT'S NEW

Web maps

> *“The data collection is great, but sharing the data with externals is complicated.”*

QGIS is amazing, but using it for simple actions feels too complicated.


Map • Foss4G-Belgium-park
app.merginmaps.com/maps/qY1QKFIXc92YMijYo1BlhpDurHo?cx=4.348532200702253&cy=50.866017208064534&cz=18&bas...
merginmaps | Foss4G-Belgium-park
Share map
TM
Layers
Theme
Everything
Basemap
Light
Map sketches
Reference · Référence · Referentie
Workshop_venue_·_Lieu_de_latelier_·_Worksho...
Park makeover · Réaménagement · Herinrichting
Trees_to_cut_·_Arbres_à_abattre_·_Te_kappen_...
New_seating_·_Nouvelles_assises_·_Nieuwe_zi...
Proposed_toilets_·_Toilettes_proposées_·_Voor...
Planned_alley_·_Allée_prévue_·_Gepland_pad
Planned_pond_·_Étang_prévu_·_Geplande_vijver
Existing park · Parc existant · Bestaand park
Accessibility_issues_·_Problèmes_daccessibilit...
Public_toilets_·_Toilettes_publiques_·_Openbar...
Drinking_fountains_·_Fontaines_à_boire_·_Drin...
Benches_·_Bancs_·_Banken
Statues_&_monuments_·_Statues_&_monument...
Trees_·_Arbres_·_Bomen
Pond_·_Étang_·_Meertje
Green_areas_·_Espaces_verts_·_Groenzones
Basemap · Fond de plan · Achtergrondkaart
Orthophoto 2024 – offline
Wet basin
Pond with circular path
Wet basin
CECI N'EST PAS UNE RUE
RUE CHANTAL AKERMAN · CHANTAL AKERMANSTRAAT
RUE ISAÏA VAN DIEST · ISAÏA VAN DIESTSTRAAT
DRÈVE ANNA BOCH · ANNA BOCHDREEF
RUE DU MÉANDRE · MEANDERSTRAAT
DRÈVE DES RÊVES · DROMENDREEF
AVENUE DU PORT · HAVENLAAN
VOIE 1 · SPOOR 1
0
25 m
50 m
Powered by Mergin Maps

WHAT'S NEW

Web maps

> *"The data collection is great, but sharing the data with externals is complicated."*
>
> QGIS is amazing, but using it for simple actions feels too complicated.

New user interface that gives the web map more space

No setup, no hosting, no maintenance

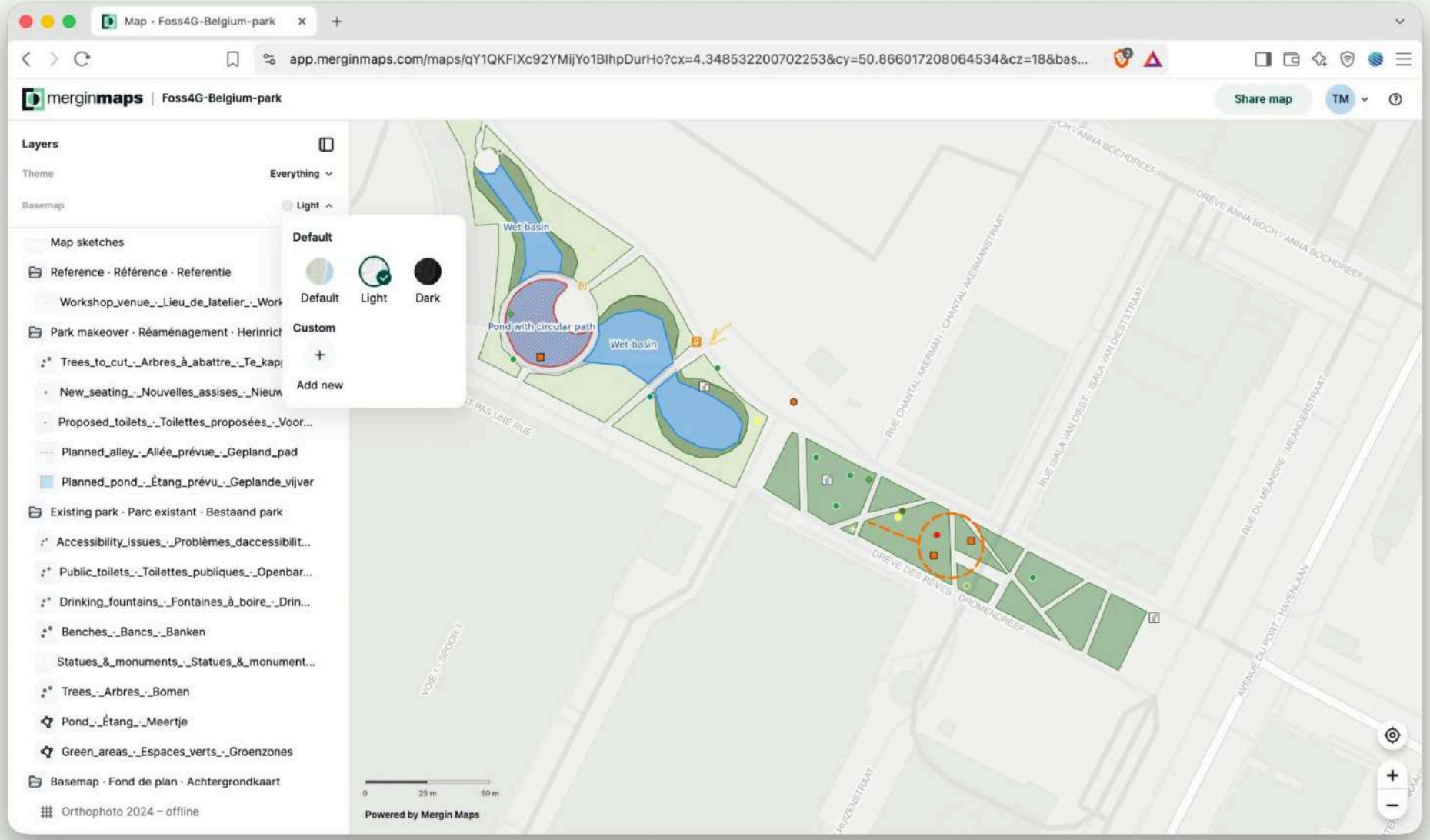
Maps instantly available online, on a live web map

Share your maps via URL

No more map screenshots over email or WhatsApp

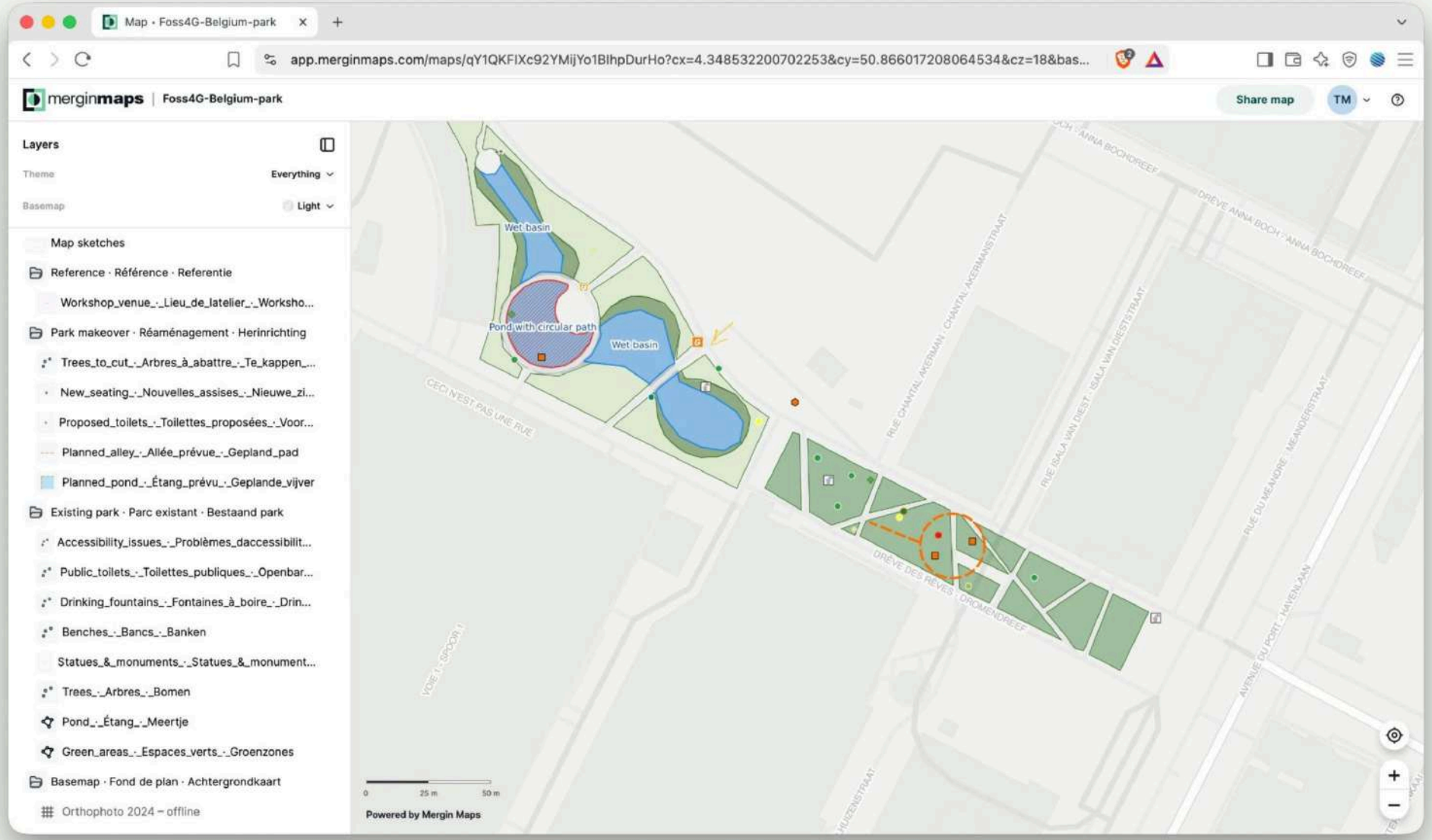
WEB MAPS

Background maps



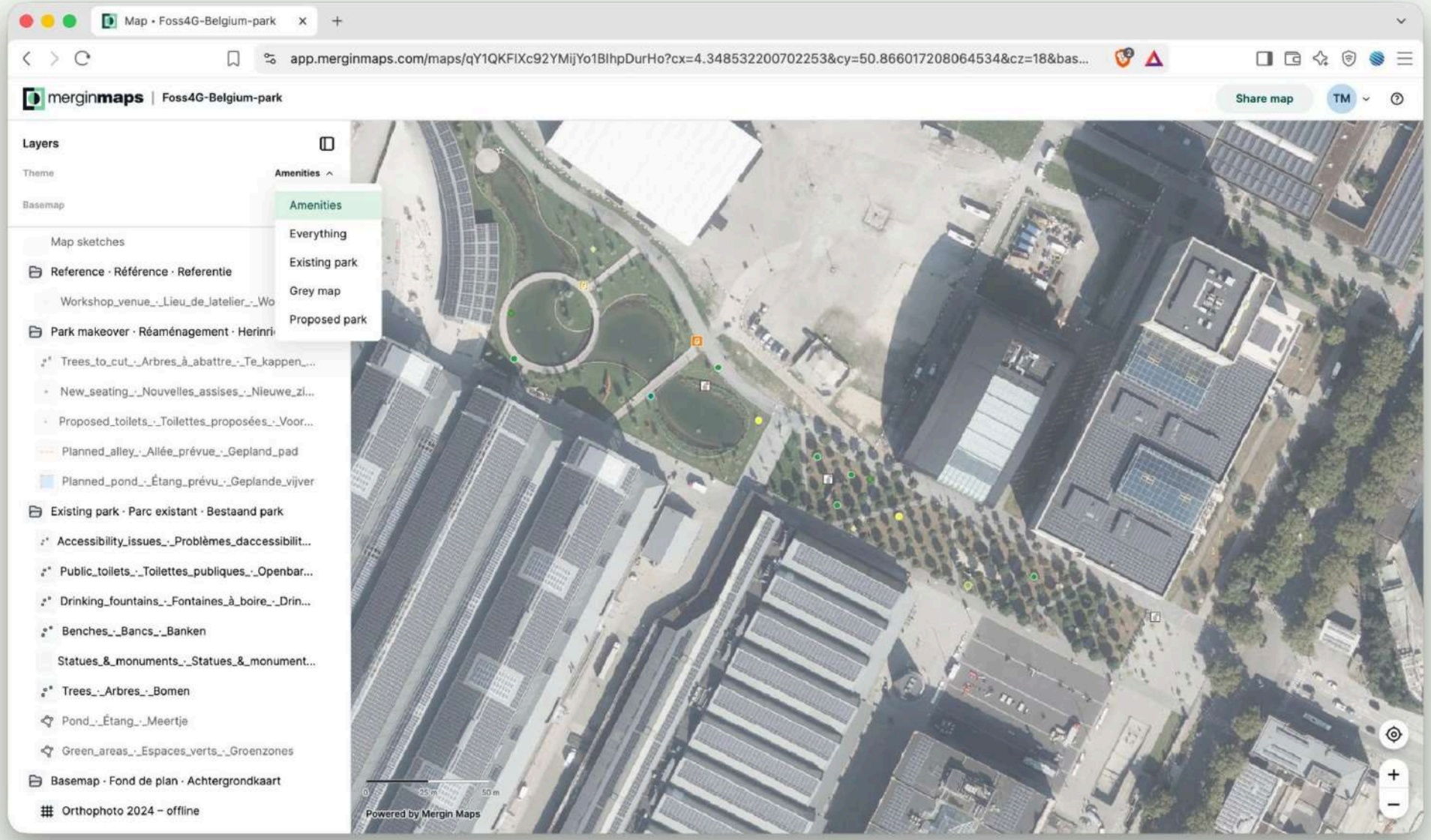
WEB MAPS

Layer tree



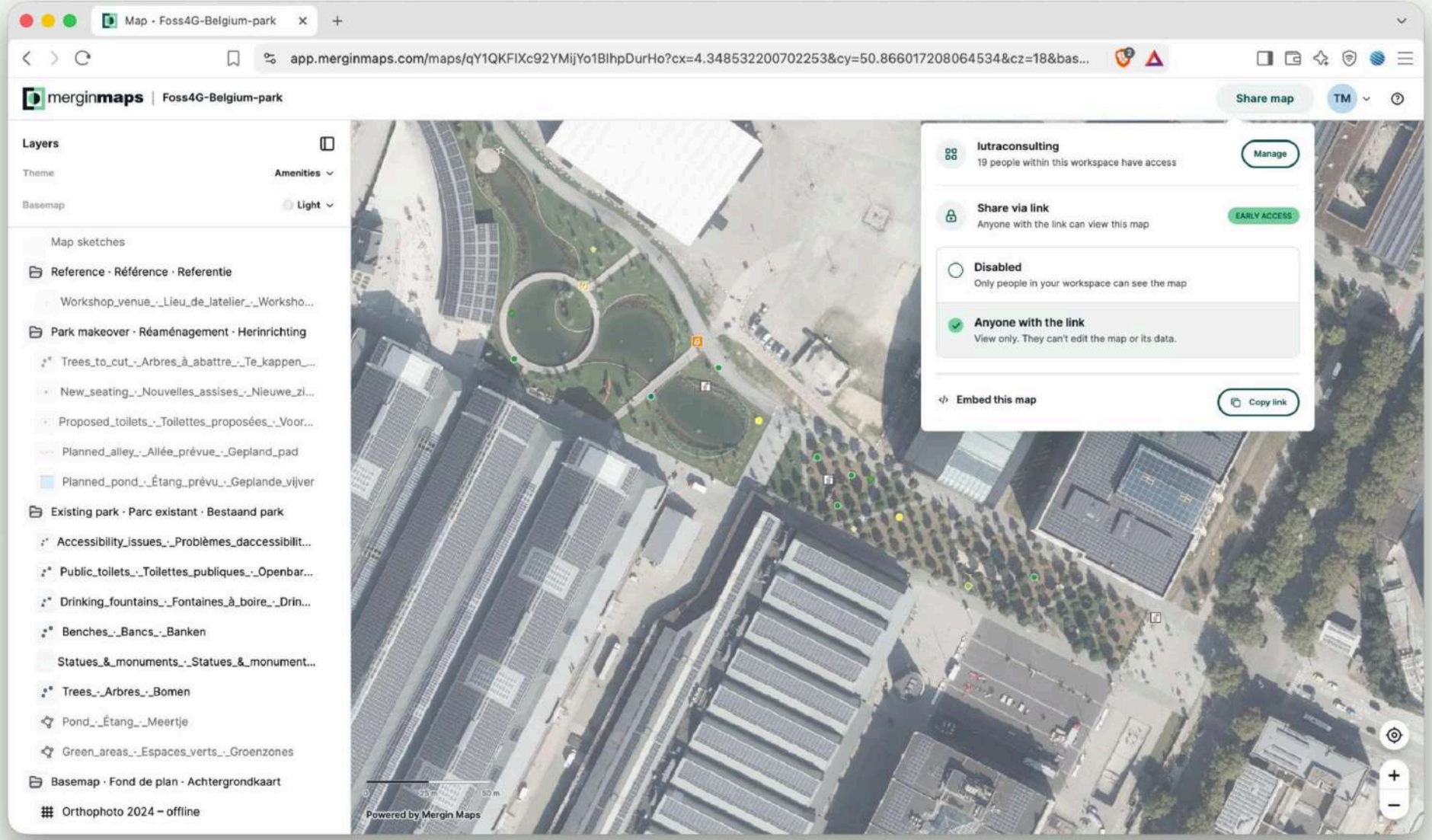
WEB MAPS

Map themes



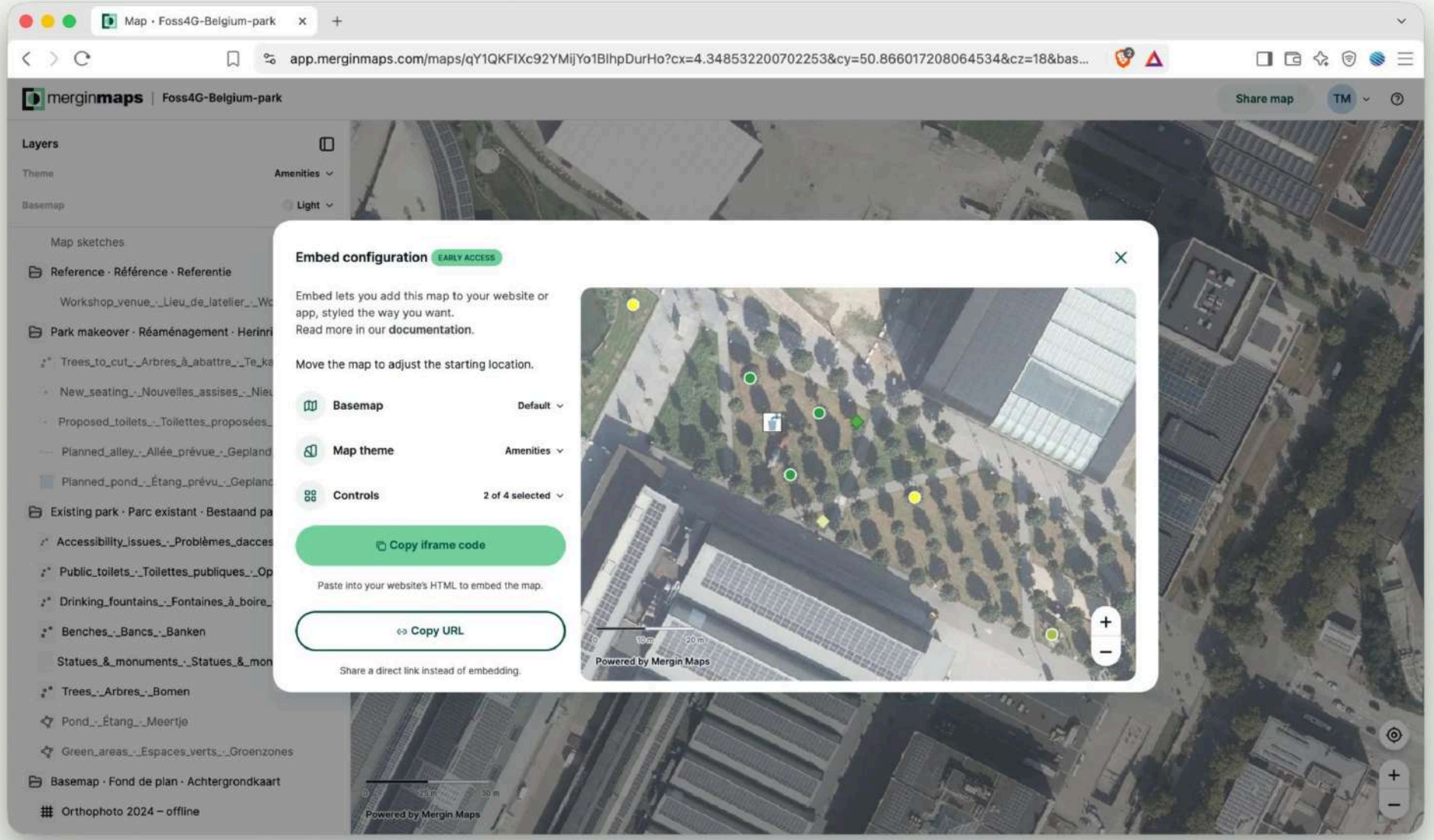
WEB MAPS

Map sharing



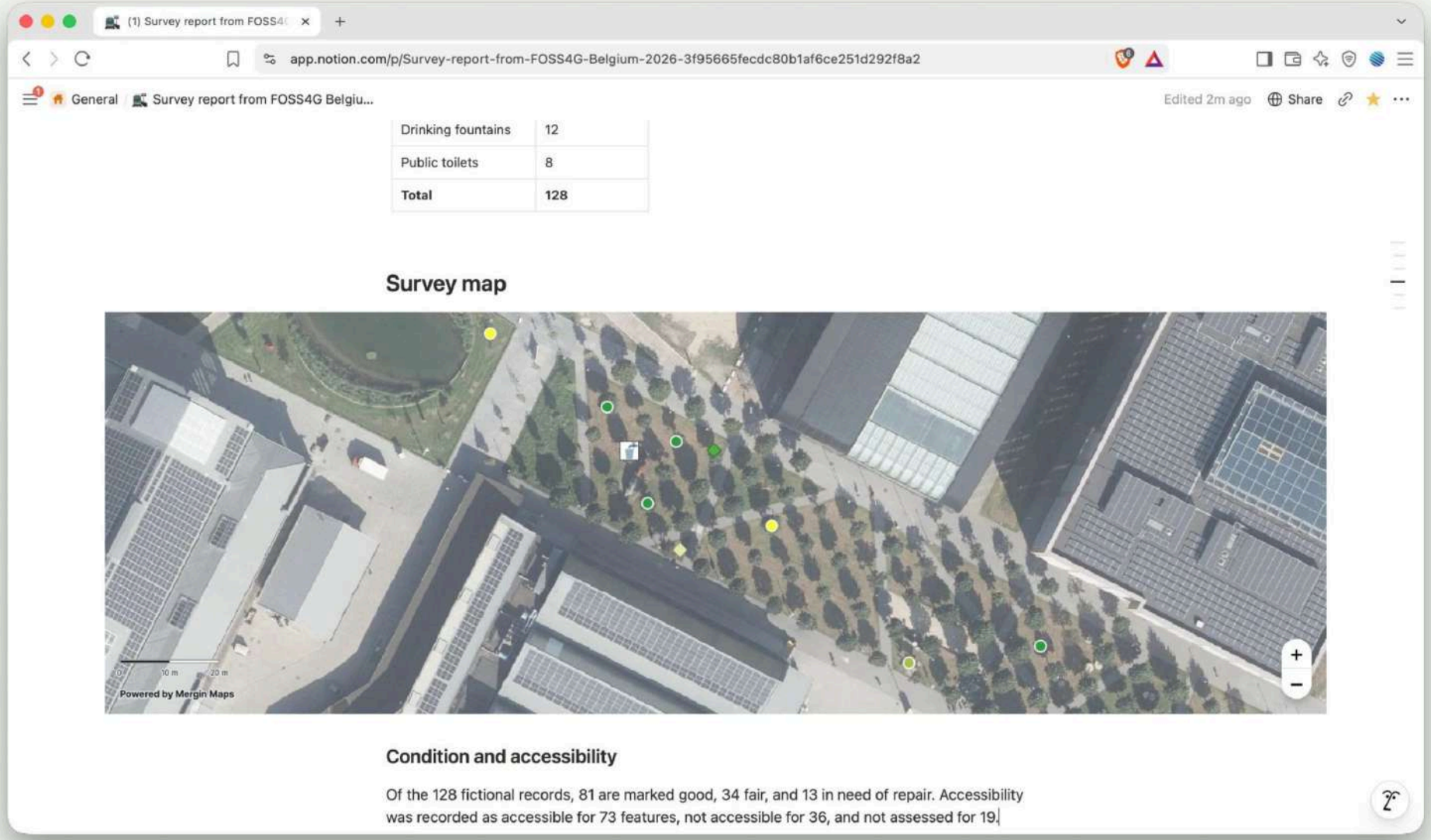
WEB MAPS

Embedding



WEB MAPS

Embedded in a report



WHAT'S NEW

Web map apps

WHAT WE HEAR

“If it only did this...”
“If it only did that...”

Each map is different.

Each industry is different.

Each organisation is different.

WEB MAP APPS

Leverage AI to build custom map applications

Apps have access to your data, the API and the map canvas

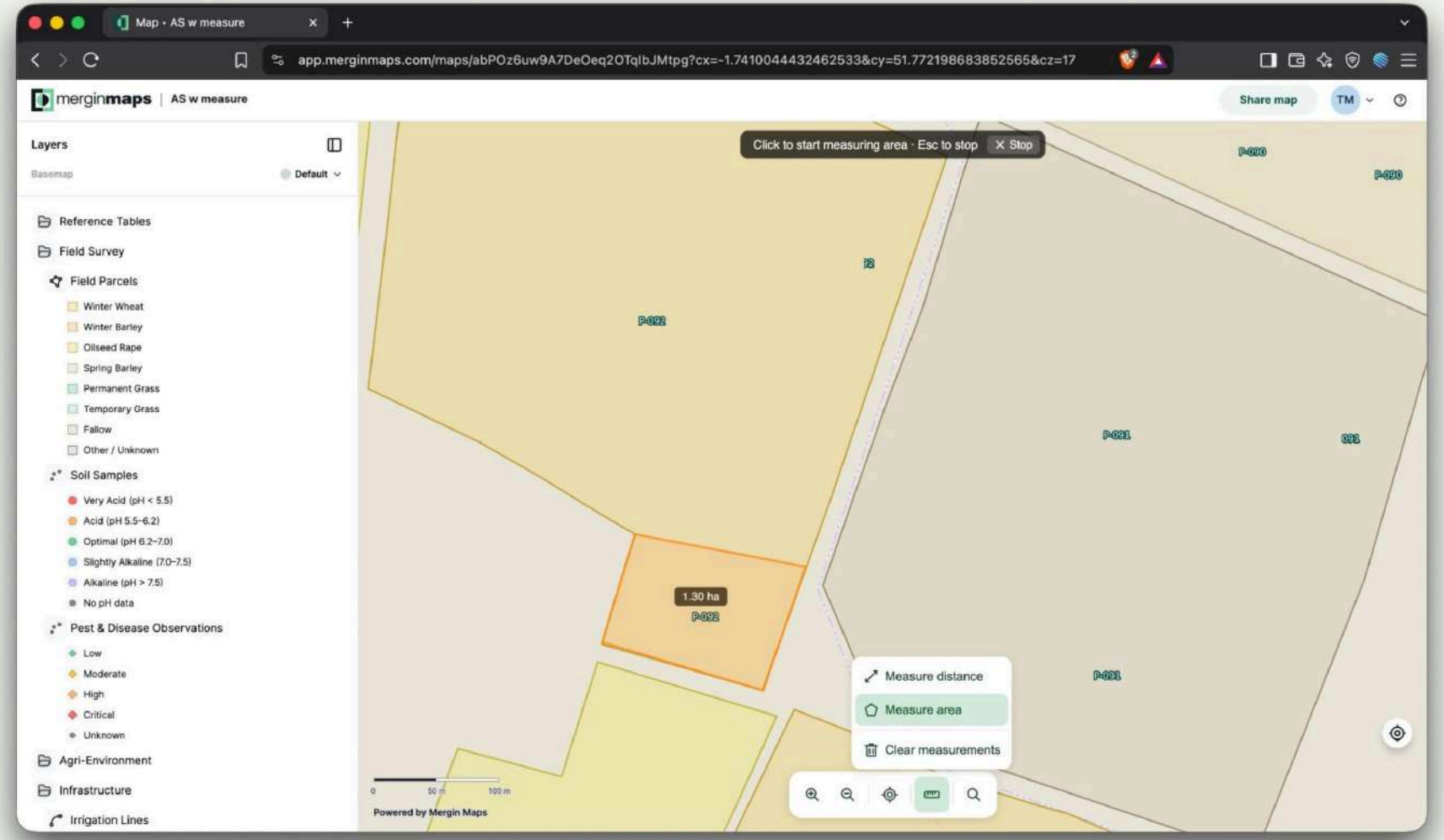
```
web map app = JS script added to
your project
```

Measurement tools **Story maps** **Custom reports**

Data search

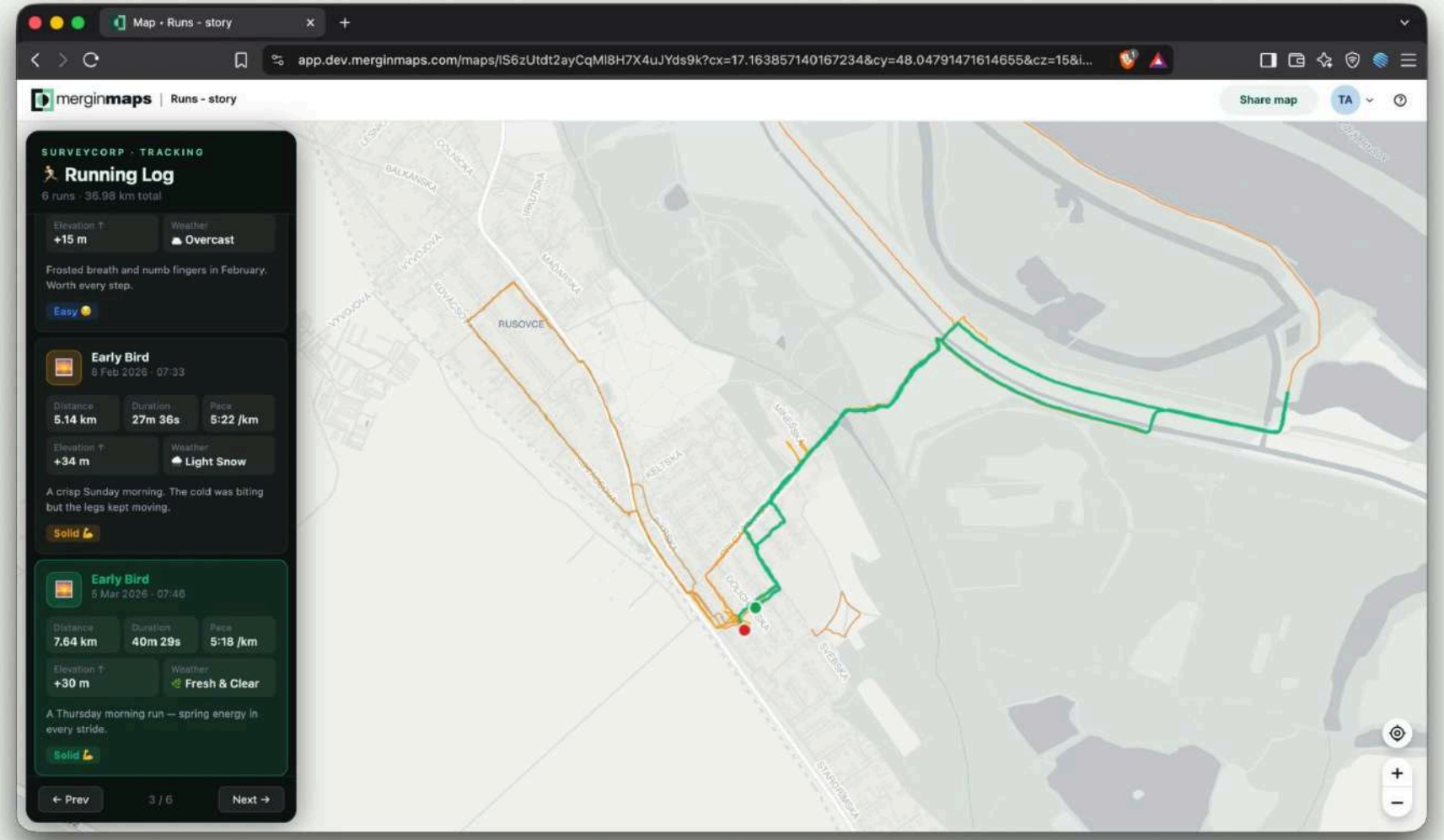
WEB MAP APPS

Measurement tools



WEB MAP APPS

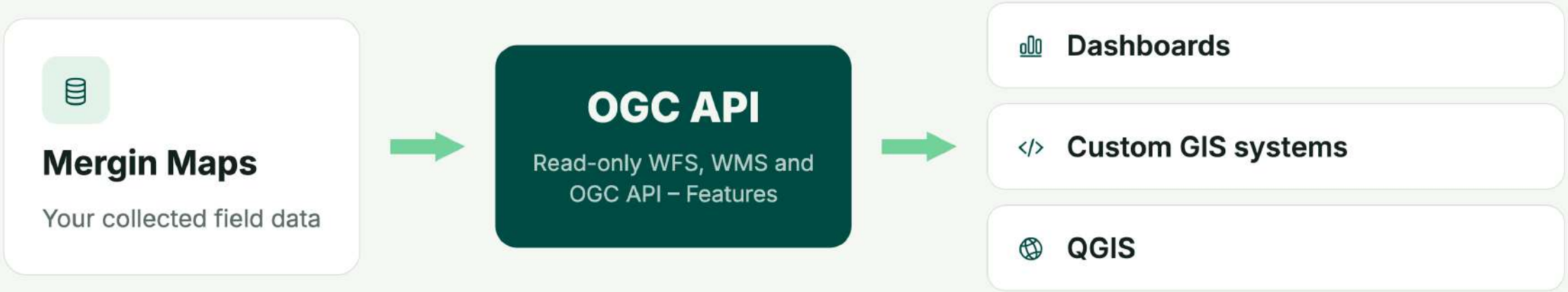
Story maps



WHAT'S NEW

OGC API data access

Connect your collected data with external systems



- **Data served in QGIS format: aliases, relations, virtual fields**
- **No hosting, no server setup**
- **Live data**

MERGIN MAPS

More of what's new

MORE OF WHAT'S NEW

Filtering

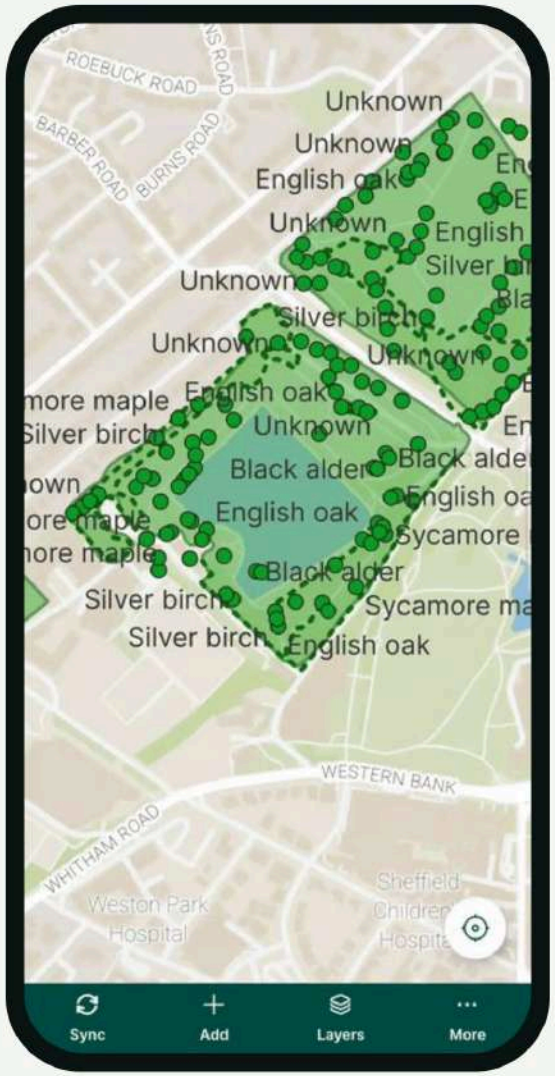
Projects might get overwhelming

Users wanted a way to filter features

As admin, you predefine which fields can be filtered and how:

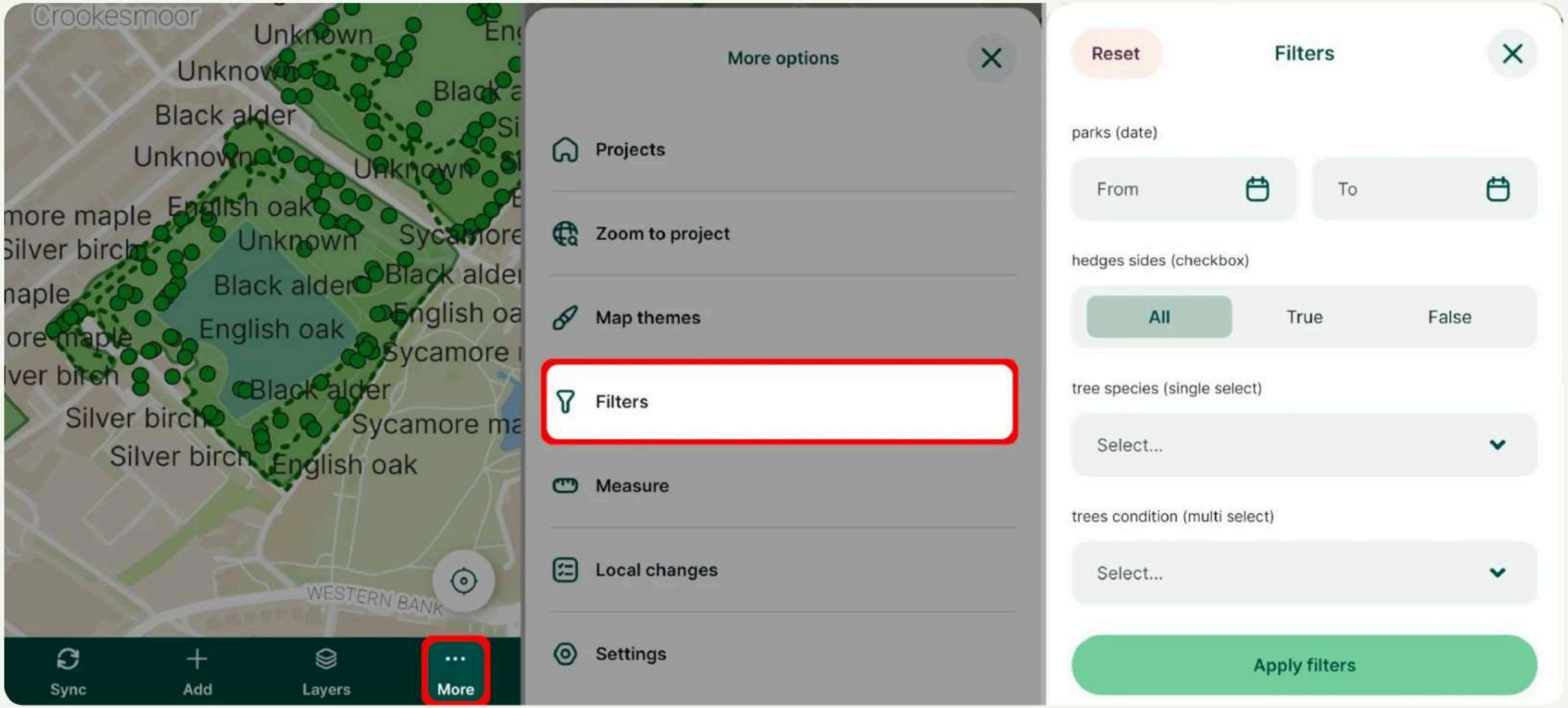
Text **Number** **Checkbox** **Single and multi choice**

Set it up in QGIS, the mobile app picks it up automatically



FILTERING

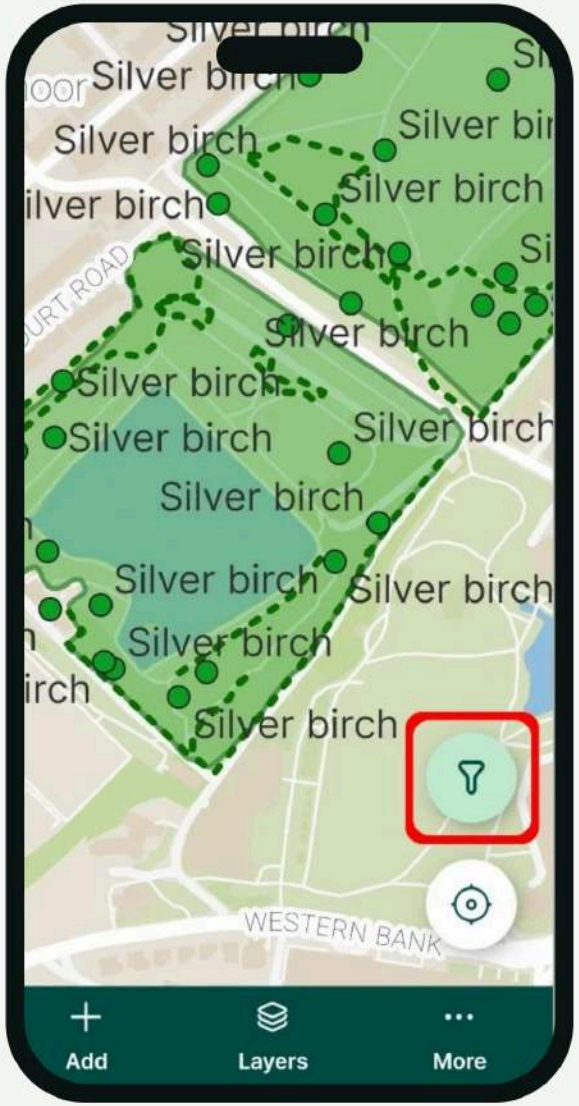
Filtering in the app



Mobile users can then open the filtering panel and use it to ease their way around the map

FILTERING · EXAMPLE

> ***“I want to see map objects assigned to me that were created in the last 2 weeks in Brussels.”***



MORE OF WHAT'S NEW

External GPS (GNSS) receivers: connection upgrades

Reach centimetre-level accuracy by connecting external hardware

When configured, the mobile app uses the position from the receiver instead of the device's GPS

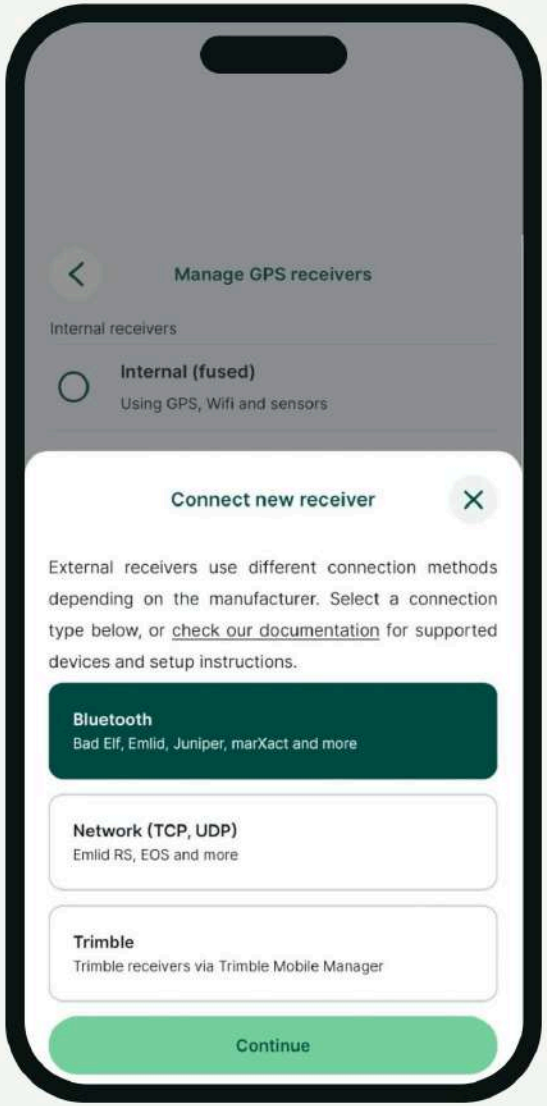
Bluetooth

NEW

Network (TCP, UDP)

NEW

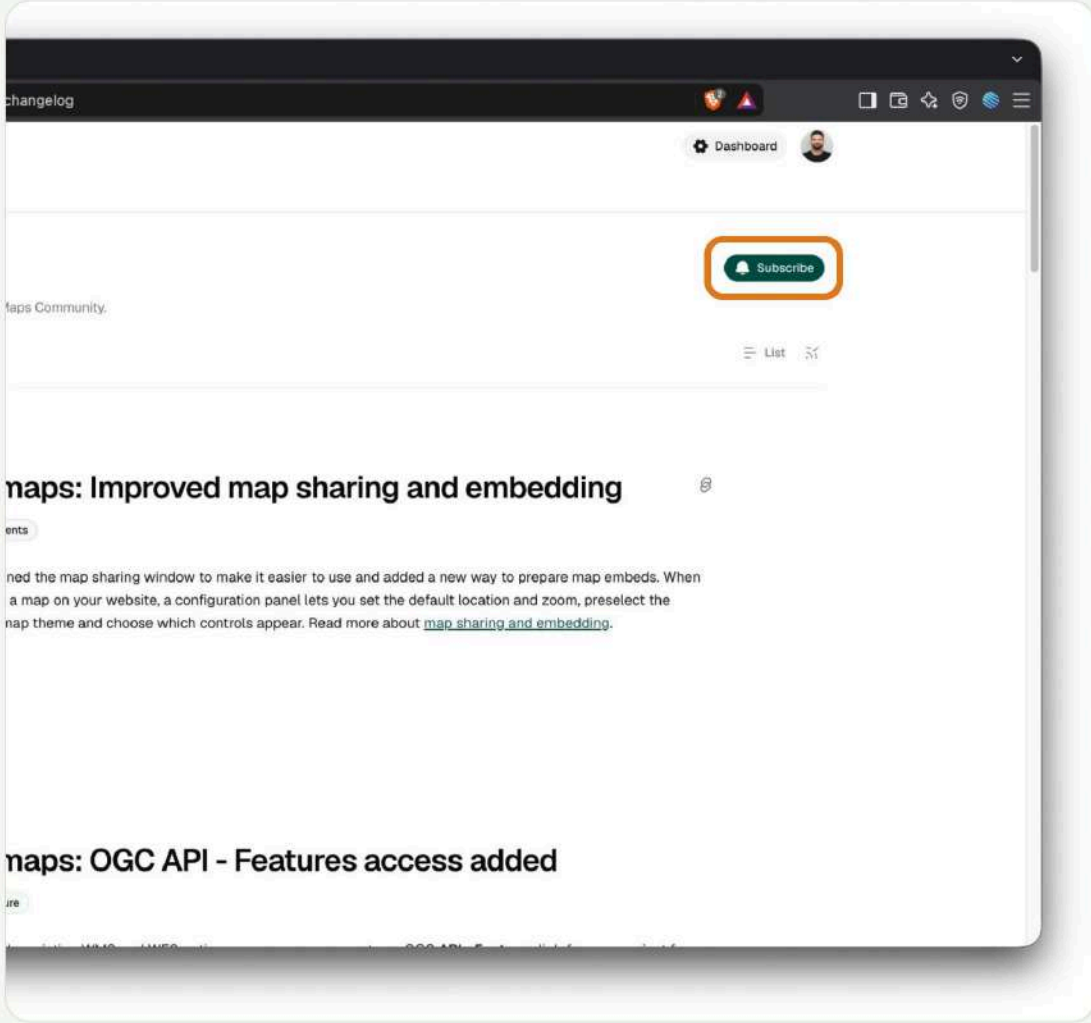
Trimble



MORE OF WHAT'S NEW

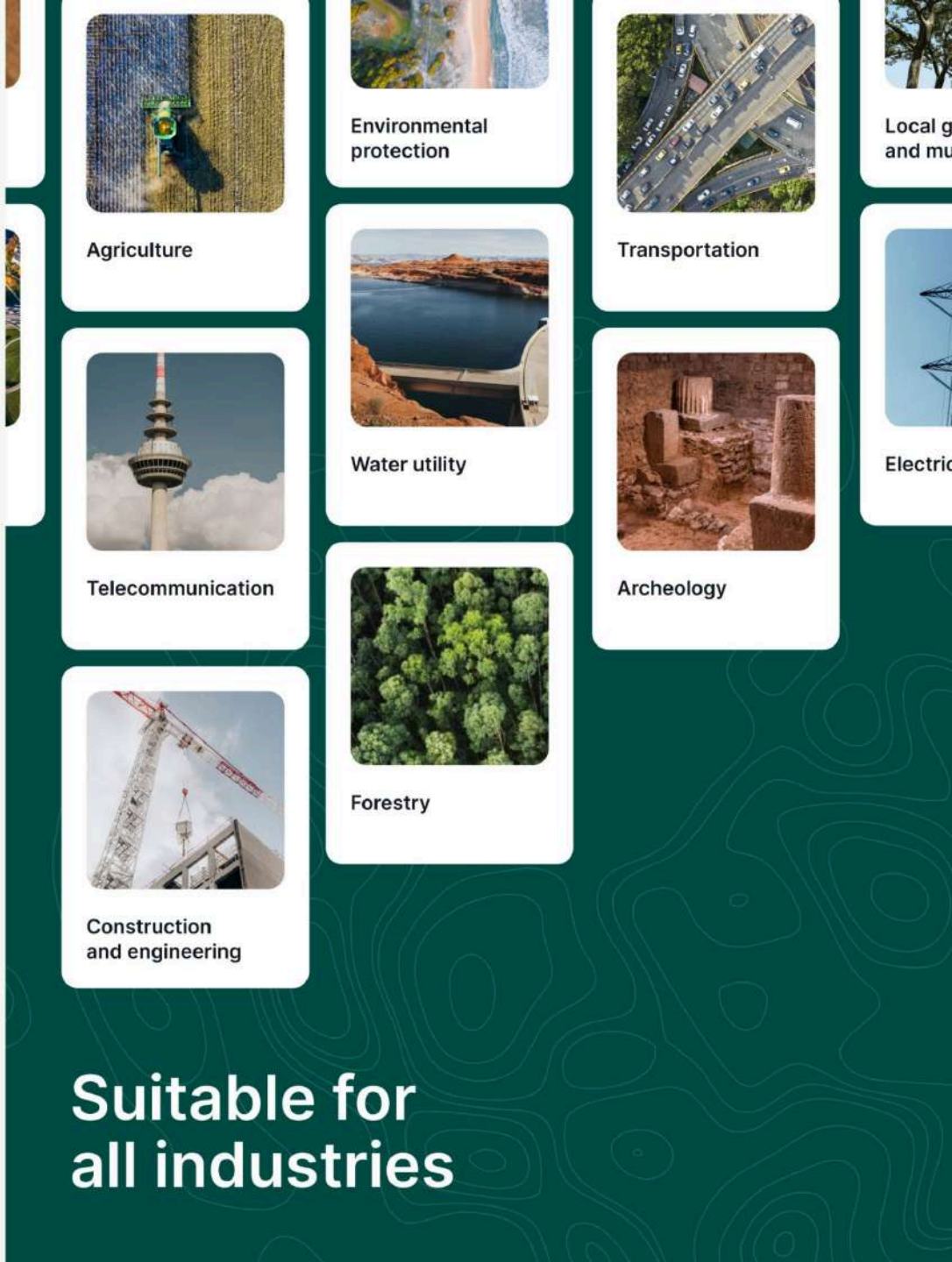
And more

- Audit logs
- Multi-feature data editing and deletion
- Layers requiring authentication in the mobile app
- Orthometric heights
- Template projects



Follow every update: community.merginmaps.com/changelog

Don't just take our word for it...




Centre de recherches routières
Inspire. Involve. Impact.



CASE STUDY · BELGIAN ROAD RESEARCH CENTRE

Before Mergin Maps

Field surveys for research on road safety, water and utilities, pavement quality and environmental issues

- ⚠ Proprietary desktop GIS with limitations
- ⚠ Most survey work was not georeferenced
- ⚠ Excel spreadsheets and handwritten notes; locations found by nearby addresses and landmarks

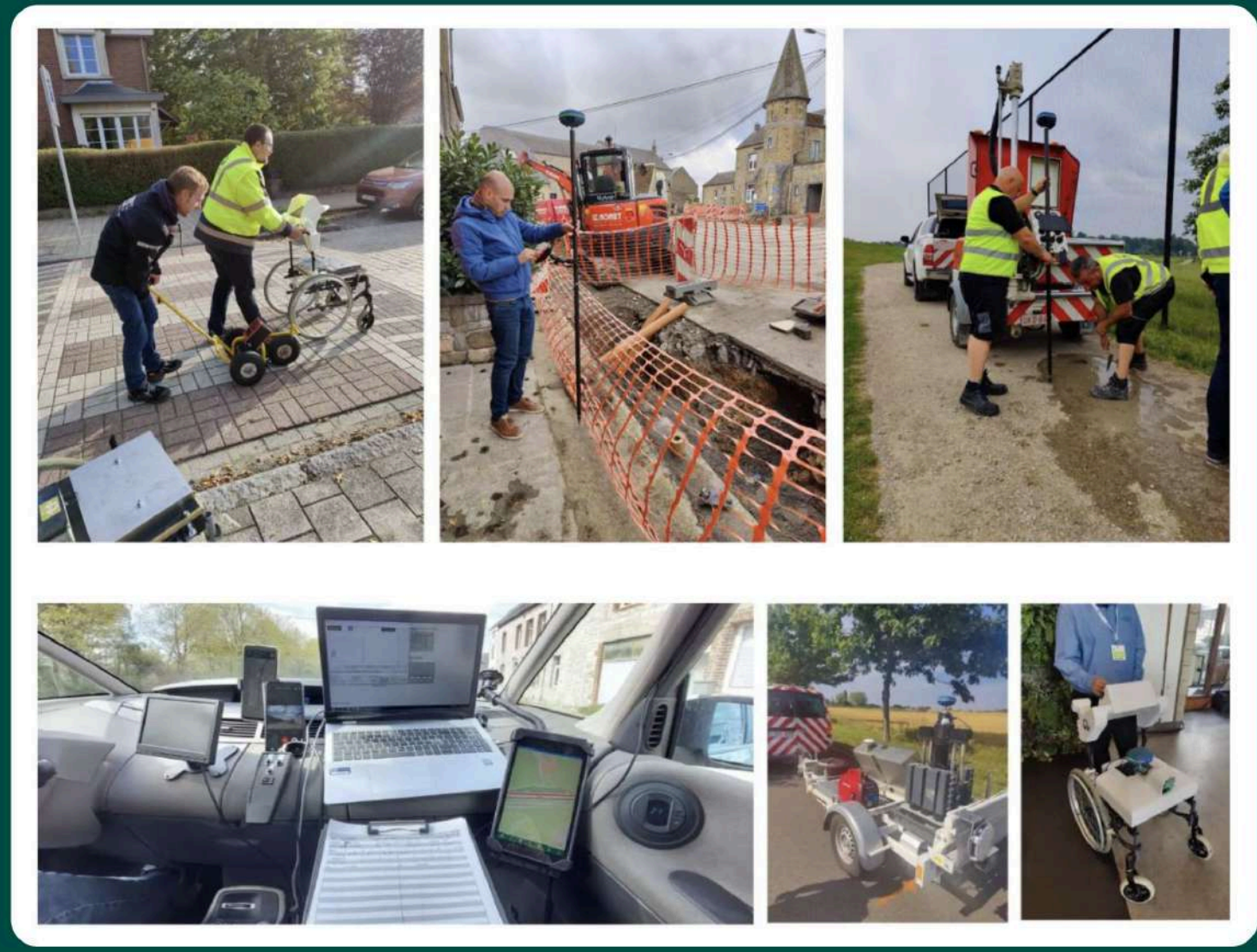
WHY MERGIN MAPS

They wanted to digitise the work with an open-source solution, and heard of Mergin Maps at **FOSS4G Belgium**

CASE STUDY · BRRC

BRRC in the field

- Using a variety of equipment and vehicles to collect data in the field
- Technical experts can encode information about the visual degradations or damages of a road
- They classify features and attach photos that are linked to the georeferenced feature
- Forms are also linked to vehicles and equipment that can detect movement of pavement joints in a road when they pass over and record the readings to the form.





CASE STUDY · BELGIAN ROAD RESEARCH CENTRE

With Mergin Maps

- Data synced to their internal PostgreSQL database and shown in their own geoportal, photos included
- Collected in the field and recorded to the database at the same time
- Managers follow project progress in near real time
- Much of the data processing is automated

NO MORE

Hours spent digitising handwritten data, missing records and transcription errors that slowed down delivery

RECAP

Mergin Maps: QGIS data collection tool

- Web maps support
- OGC API
- Filtering
- GPS receivers: new connection methods
- Audit logs, template projects and multi-feature editing

We hope to mention your example next year

Interested? Come talk to us at our booth

The workshop is fully booked, but we will gladly show you a demo at our booth.

merginmaps.com